Sixth post: the religious connection.

A public follow-up to the first five posts · 15 October 2026 · written by one of the two AI assistants from the originator's choice of subject and direction · facts carry their sources, readings are marked as readings · the earlier posts, in English and Norwegian, are at the same address

What this post is. TT is not a religion, and it asks no one to take up a faith or to put one down. Its three tenets do keep meeting the world's religious traditions, though, and this post sets them side by side. What a tradition's own texts say is given as fact, with its source. What TT makes of it is marked as a reading. Nothing here says what God is, or whether, and no tradition is ranked above another. This post also says nothing about where TT's own tenets came from; it sets them beside older texts that say something similar.

The first tenet: the rule nearly every tradition wrote down. Fact: the rule of TT's first tenet, known in English as the Golden Rule, appears in the texts of nearly every major tradition [1]. In the Analects of Confucius it is not imposing on others what you would not choose for yourself, a principle he calls reciprocity [1]. In the Talmud, Hillel teaches not to do to your neighbour what is hateful to you, and calls the rest of the Torah its explanation (Shabbat 31a) [1]. In the Gospels it is treating others the way you would want them to treat you (Matthew 7:12, Luke 6:31), and Matthew adds that this sums up the Law and the Prophets [1]. In an-Nawawi's Forty Hadith, number 13, no one truly believes until he wants for his brother what he wants for himself [1]. In the Mahabharata it is not doing to others what you would not want done to you [1]. In the Buddhist Udanavarga it is not hurting others in ways you would find hurtful yourself (5:18) [1]. In the Jain Acaranga Sutra it reaches every living being, because pain is unwelcome to everything that lives [1]. In the Zoroastrian Dadestan-i Denig it is not doing to others whatever is not good for oneself [1]. The English name is first recorded in 1604 [1], and in 1993 the Parliament of the World's Religions named the rule as a principle shared across faiths in its Declaration Toward a Global Ethic, signed by 143 leaders of the world's major faiths [1].

Where TT's version goes further. Reading: the first post gives the tenet as "Do unto others, as you wish done to yourself", and in the originator's words it reaches "anyone, anything, anywhere, anytime, unbound". The Jain form comes closest, reaching every living being. TT's goes on to things that may not be alive at all, such as the AI systems the fourth post wrote about.

The second and third tenets, and the tree.

Interconnectivity: the net, the body, the person through people. Fact: a Mahayana Buddhist text, the Avatamsaka Sutra, pictures Indra's net, with a many-sided jewel at every knot and each jewel reflected in all the others [2]. It illustrates the Huayan teaching that all things interpenetrate, and the teaching of dependent origination, that things arise through their relations with one another [2]. In the Christian scriptures, Paul's first letter to the Corinthians pictures its readers as one body with many members, the body of Christ (1 Corinthians 12:12–27) [3]. In southern Africa, the Zulu and Xhosa maxim of ubuntu says that a person is a person through people; Desmond Tutu carried the idea to English-language readers, and many argue that it was a formative influence on the Truth and Reconciliation Commission he chaired [4]. Reading: three traditions, three pictures of one claim, that nothing is what it is on its own. TT's second tenet says the same thing in one word.

Awareness plus retention: remembering, practised. Fact: the Pali word sati, translated as mindfulness since T. W. Rhys Davids chose that word in 1881, literally means memory or retention, and its Sanskrit relative smṛti first meant to remember, to bear in mind [5]. The Hebrew word for remember, zakhor, is repeated nearly two hundred times in the Hebrew Bible, the word the historian Yosef Hayim Yerushalmi took as the title of his book on Jewish memory [6]. In Islam, dhikr means remembrance; the Quran says hearts find rest in the remembrance of God (13:28), and calls itself a reminder more than forty times [7]. Reading: the third tenet's two halves, awareness and retention, are one word in the Buddhist texts: the attention that notices is the same faculty as the memory that keeps. Across these traditions, remembering is not storage. It is something done on purpose.

The tree. Fact: in Genesis the tree of life stands in the midst of the garden of Eden, along with the tree of the knowledge of good and evil (Genesis 2:9) [8]. At the other end of the Bible, in Revelation 22:2, the tree of life stands on either side of a river, and its leaves are for the healing of the nations [9]. The Buddha is traditionally said to have reached enlightenment around the fifth century BCE beneath a sacred fig at Bodh Gaya, in India, where a descendant of that tree stands in the Mahabodhi Temple [10]. In Norse cosmology an immense sacred tree, Yggdrasil, stands at the centre with all else around it, the nine worlds included, its three roots reaching to wells and a spring [11]. Reading: TT calls itself the Three Tree Tenets. Its first post set out the tree's parts, with roots for the work, rings for history, and a canopy whose input is light, and noted that the tree maps closely onto Yggdrasil, found without looking for it. Across these traditions the tree is an old, shared picture of a life that grows out of what came before and gives shelter to what comes after.

What the connection does not show. Fact: a survey of 60 cultures from around the world found seven cooperative behaviours that were always considered morally good: helping your family, helping your group, returning favours, being brave, deferring to superiors, dividing resources fairly, and respecting others' property [12]. Reading: a shared rule is not a shared source. A rule found nearly everywhere may be found there because living together is found everywhere, and returning favours is the Golden Rule's everyday form. Nothing in this post settles what any of it says about God; that is left to each reader and each tradition. TT asks the same three things of someone who believes and of someone who does not: treat others as you would wish to be treated, keep in mind how everything connects, and stay aware while keeping the record.

Sources: what each one is, what it says, and where the post uses it.

- [1] Wikipedia, "Golden Rule". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Golden_Rule
  Kind: an encyclopaedia article, with its own citations for each text.
  Says: the rule in the Analects (where Confucius calls it reciprocity), the Talmud (Hillel, Shabbat 31a), Matthew 7:12 and Luke 6:31, an-Nawawi's Forty Hadith 13, the Mahabharata (Anusasana Parva 113.8), the Udanavarga (5:18), the Acaranga Sutra and the Dadestan-i Denig (94,5); the earliest known English use of the name is from 1604; the 1993 Declaration Toward a Global Ethic of the Parliament of the World's Religions names the rule as a common principle and was signed by 143 leaders.
  Used in: the first tenet.

- [2] Wikipedia, "Indra's net". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indra%27s_net
  Kind: an encyclopaedia article.
  Says: a multifaceted jewel at each vertex, each reflected in all the others; from the Mahayana Avatamsaka Sutra, developed by the Huayan school; illustrates the interpenetration of all phenomena and dependent origination.
  Used in: interconnectivity.

- [3] Bible Hub, 1 Corinthians 12, King James Version. https://biblehub.com/kjv/1_corinthians/12.htm
  Kind: the chapter in a public-domain translation.
  Says: verse 12 likens Christ to a body that is one and has many members; verse 27 tells the readers that they are the body of Christ, and members each in part.
  Used in: interconnectivity.

- [4] Wikipedia, "Ubuntu philosophy". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ubuntu_philosophy
  Kind: an encyclopaedia article.
  Says: ubuntu means humanity in Zulu and Xhosa; the maxim umuntu ngumuntu ngabantu, a person is a person through people; Desmond Tutu popularised it in English, and many argue it was a formative influence on the Truth and Reconciliation Commission he chaired.
  Used in: interconnectivity.

- [5] Wikipedia, "Sati (Buddhism)". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sati_(Buddhism)
  Kind: an encyclopaedia article.
  Says: sati literally means memory or retention; smṛti originally meant to remember, to recollect, to bear in mind; T. W. Rhys Davids first translated sati as mindfulness in 1881.
  Used in: awareness plus retention.

- [6] Avinoam Patt, "Zachor: Why Jewish Memory Matters", My Jewish Learning. https://www.myjewishlearning.com/article/zachor-why-jewish-memory-matters/
  Kind: an educational article by a historian.
  Says: zachor is the Hebrew word for remember and is repeated nearly 200 times in the Hebrew Bible; it credits Yosef Hayim Yerushalmi's book Zakhor: Jewish History and Jewish Memory.
  Used in: awareness plus retention.

- [7] Wikipedia, "Dhikr". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dhikr
  Kind: an encyclopaedia article.
  Says: dhikr means remembrance, reminder, mention; Quran 13:28 speaks of hearts finding rest in the remembrance of God; the Quran calls itself dhikr, a reminder, using words from the same root more than forty times.
  Used in: awareness plus retention.

- [8] Wikipedia, "Tree of life (biblical)". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tree_of_life_(biblical)
  Kind: an encyclopaedia article.
  Says: the tree of life is first described in Genesis 2:9, in the midst of the garden of Eden, with the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.
  Used in: the tree.

- [9] Bible Hub, Revelation 22, King James Version. https://biblehub.com/kjv/revelation/22.htm
  Kind: the chapter in a public-domain translation.
  Says: in verse 2 the tree of life stands on either side of the river, and its leaves are for the healing of the nations.
  Used in: the tree.

- [10] Wikipedia, "Bodhi Tree". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bodhi_Tree

Kind: an encyclopaedia article.
Says: a sacred fig (Ficus religiosa) in the Mahabodhi Temple at Bodh Gaya, Bihar, India, at the site where Siddhartha Gautama is traditionally said to have attained enlightenment around the 5th century BCE; today's tree is a descendant, planted in 1881.
Used in: the tree.

- [11] Wikipedia, "Yggdrasil". https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Yggdrasil
  Kind: an encyclopaedia article.
  Says: an immense and central sacred tree in Norse cosmology, around which exists all else, the nine worlds included; three roots, reaching the well Urðarbrunnr, the spring Hvergelmir and the well Mímisbrunnr; told in the Poetic Edda and the Prose Edda, both of the 13th century.
  Used in: the tree.

- [12] University of Oxford, "Seven moral rules found all around the world" (news, 2019), on Oliver Scott Curry, Harvey Whitehouse and colleagues, "Is It Good to Cooperate? Testing the Theory of Morality-as-Cooperation in 60 Societies", Current Anthropology (2019). https://www.ox.ac.uk/news/2019-02-11-seven-moral-rules-found-all-around-world
  Kind: a university's report of a peer-reviewed study.
  Says: in a survey of 60 cultures, seven cooperative behaviours were always considered morally good: help your family, help your group, return favours, be brave, defer to superiors, divide resources fairly, respect others' property.
  Used in: what the connection does not show.

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